

GROUP PROJECT

INFORMATION SYSTEMS 1781

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THE INFORMATION SYSTEMS CONSULTANT'S PROJECT

The role of an information systems consultant is to provide expert guidance to organisations regarding their information systems, technology infrastructure, and data management. Consultants are employed across virtually every sector of the economy, from government and education to retail and agriculture, and their ability to apply IS principles to real-world business problems is what makes them valuable.

This project places you in the role of an IS consultant working with an organisation in a sector of your choice. You will investigate how information systems can be used to improve that organisation's operations, decision-making, and data practices, while navigating the ethical, technical, and organisational challenges that real consultants face.

Note: Independent research will be required.

SCENARIO CHOICES

Scenario 1: Smart Municipality

A mid-sized South African municipality is really struggling with fragmented service delivery. Residents report frustrations with billing errors, permit delays, and poor communication during outages. The municipal manager has appointed your team as IS consultants to develop a digital resource that will help the municipality's administrative staff and managers understand how information systems can improve service delivery, data quality, and decision-making. Your resource should help non-technical staff understand why IS matters and how it can be implemented responsibly in a public-sector environment.

Scenario 2: SME Digital Transformation - Retail and Small Business

A small South African retail business has been operating using spreadsheets, old-fashioned paper records, and manual processes. The owner wants to grow the business but recognises that the current approach to managing inventory, customer data, and finances will not scale larger. Your team has been appointed as IS consultants to develop a digital resource that educates the business owner and staff on how information systems, including integrated software, data management practices, and analytics tools, can transform their operations. The resource should be practical, accessible to a non-technical audience, and grounded in the real trade-offs a small business faces.

Scenario 3: Higher Education IS Audit

A private higher education institution is reviewing its information systems landscape. Its student management system, learning management system, and finance system were implemented at different times and do not communicate effectively with one another. Academic staff struggle to access timely data, and student records are inconsistently maintained. Your team has been

appointed as IS consultants to develop a digital resource that helps academic managers, administrators, and IT staff understand how to evaluate, integrate, and improve the institution's information systems, with particular attention to data quality, privacy, and decision support.

Scenario 4: AgriTech and Food Supply Chain

A smallholder farming cooperative in South Africa is working with an agri-processing company to bring its produce to market more efficiently. The partnership is hampered by poor information flow between the farm, the processing facility, and the retailers. Decisions about planting, logistics, and pricing are made without reliable data, and there are concerns about who owns the farmers' data and how it is being used. Your team has been appointed as IS consultants to develop a digital resource that helps stakeholders across the supply chain understand how information systems can improve coordination, data quality, and ethical data practices in an agricultural context.

INSTRUCTIONS

What to produce?

Your team will create a professional website that serves as a digital IS resource for staff and managers in your chosen sector. The website should be both educational and practical, designed so that a busy professional with limited IT knowledge can read it, navigate it independently, and come away with a genuine understanding of the IS concepts that are most relevant to their organisation. Your website must address the following topics. **One topic** must be explored in significant depth, with detailed explanations, relevant examples, and practical guidance tailored to your sector:

1. Data and information management in your sector (including data visualisation, dashboards, and information quality)
2. Data ethics, privacy, and POPIA compliance in your sector
3. AI and decision support systems relevant to your sector
4. Enterprise systems and IS integration challenges in your sector
5. Adapting and customising information systems to fit your organisation's specific needs

You may enrich your website with additional media such as embedded videos, interactive diagrams, or data dashboards, provided these add genuine value and are not used to compensate for weak written content.

Presentation and Client Q&A

Your project will be presented during class on 14 and 15 October 2026. Presentation timeslots will be published on BC Connect. The presentation will be posed as a client pitch: your team will present your website to the lecturer, who will play the role of your client. You will walk the

audience through your resource and explain the rationale behind your choices. Following the presentation, there will be a Q&A session in which your lecturer will probe your decisions, challenge your assumptions, or ask you to apply your IS knowledge to a new scenario. You should be prepared to answer questions that go beyond your website content and demonstrate genuine understanding of the concepts you have covered.

It is advisable that you appoint a project leader who will track milestones, assign tasks, and check deadlines. You will be able to use either your own device, or the lecturer's PC when presenting your website. You might also consider hosting your website on a free hosting service.

What to submit on BC Connect?

Submit a design rationale as a PDF document on BC Connect. In this document, include the following information:

1. The main headings of your website with your thinking behind selecting these headings.
2. For each heading, display its content and add your reasoning behind including this content.
3. Structure your document logically e.g., if you have sub-topics, these should be organised and displayed accordingly.
4. Include a brief section where each member's tasks and contributions are shown.
5. At the end of your document, include an 'AI Disclaimer' where you explicitly state how you used AI in your project.

IMPORTANT NOTES

- This project must be completed in groups of four to five students.
- Each group must select one scenario.
- You will not be assessed on your web programming skills and may use AI to assist you with creation of the website.
- All team members are expected to contribute to both the content of the website and the design rationale document. The Q&A session may include questions directed at individual team members.
Note: All members should be able to answer any question posed.
- Your website should appear professional and be ready for distribution to a real client.
- You will be given time during class to work on this project and may consult the lecturer for guidance.
- See the rubric below for detailed information on how your project will be assessed.
- During your presentation, avoid overreliance on cards or your phone. Aim for an authentic, business-like presentation.
- It is **your responsibility** to manage group dynamics appropriately.

A note on AI tools:

Artificial intelligence tools may be used to assist with the technical construction of your website, for example, to generate layout suggestions, write or debug code, create visual elements, or troubleshoot design problems. This is considered an acceptable use of AI as a productivity tool, in the same way that a professional might use AI to assist with the technical aspects of building a client deliverable.

You may not, however, use AI to generate the written content of your website

GRADING

Please go through the rubric below and ensure your project and presentation sufficiently cover all the criteria.

CRITERIA	EXCELLENT	GOOD	SATISFACTORY	NEEDS IMPROVEMENT	INADEQUATE	WEIGHT
Content Quality, Accuracy, and Relevance	IS concepts are explained accurately and in depth, with strong relevance to the chosen sector. All claims are supported with appropriate sources.	IS concepts are generally accurate and relevant to the chosen sector, with most claims supported.	IS concepts are mostly accurate but lack depth or sector-specific relevance in places. Some claims are unsupported.	Several inaccuracies or gaps in IS content. Limited connection to the chosen sector.	Significant inaccuracies, missing content, or no meaningful connection to the chosen sector.	20%
Website Design and Usability	Professional, visually consistent, and easy to navigate. A non-technical user could use the website independently without confusion.	Well-designed and generally easy to navigate. Minor usability issues that do not significantly impede use.	Adequate design with some navigation or usability issues. The website is functional but not polished.	Basic design with noticeable usability problems. Navigation is unclear or inconsistent.	Poor design that makes the website difficult to use. Navigation is broken or absent.	15%
Scenario Application and Contextualisation	All IS content is convincingly grounded in the chosen sector. Examples,	IS content is mostly contextualised to the chosen sector	IS content is connected to the sector in general terms but lacks specific examples	Limited connection to the chosen sector. Content could apply to any context.	No meaningful contextualisation. Content is entirely generic.	15%

	terminology, and case studies are specific and realistic.	with relevant examples.	or realistic application.			
Client Pitch and Q&A	Presentation is professional and well-structured. The team demonstrates confident, detailed knowledge during Q&A and responds convincingly to probing questions and new scenarios.	Presentation is clear and well-prepared. The team handles most Q&A questions competently.	Presentation covers the key points. Q&A responses are adequate but lack depth or confidence.	Presentation is incomplete or poorly structured. Q&A responses are vague or inconsistent with the website content.	Presentation is unprepared or incoherent. Q&A reveals minimal understanding of the project content.	15%
Teamwork and Collaboration	Exceptional evidence of coordinated effort, shared workload, and effective communication throughout the project.	Good evidence of teamwork and shared contribution among all members.	Adequate teamwork with some evidence of collaboration, though contribution may be uneven.	Limited evidence of collaboration. Contribution appears to have come from one or two members.	No meaningful evidence of teamwork or shared contribution.	10%
IS Concepts: Data and Information Management	Thorough and accurate coverage of data management, information quality, and data	Good coverage of data management and information quality with	Basic coverage of data and information management. Key concepts are	Limited or inaccurate coverage of data management concepts.	Minimal or no coverage of data and information management.	5%

	visualisation, with sector-specific examples and practical insight.	relevant examples.	present but lack depth or application.			
IS Concepts: Ethics, Privacy, and Security	Comprehensive and nuanced treatment of data ethics, POPIA obligations, and security considerations in the chosen sector.	Good treatment of ethics and privacy with relevant examples and clear reference to POPIA.	Adequate coverage of ethics and privacy. POPIA is mentioned but not applied with depth.	Superficial treatment of ethics or privacy. POPIA is referenced incorrectly or barely mentioned.	Minimal or no treatment of ethics, privacy, or security.	5%
IS Concepts: Enterprise Systems and Integration	Detailed and accurate explanation of enterprise systems and IS integration challenges, grounded in the chosen sector.	Good explanation of enterprise systems and integration with relevant sector context.	Basic explanation of enterprise systems. Integration challenges are mentioned but not explored.	Limited or inaccurate coverage of enterprise systems or integration.	Minimal or no coverage of enterprise systems or IS integration.	5%
IS Concepts: Analytics and Decision Support	Detailed and accurate coverage of analytics and decision support, including relevant maturity levels or decision types,	Good coverage of analytics and decision support with relevant sector examples.	Basic coverage of analytics and decision support. Concepts are present but not applied with depth.	Limited or inaccurate coverage of analytics or decision support.	Minimal or no coverage of analytics or decision support.	5%

	applied to the chosen sector.					
Depth in One IS Area	One area of the website demonstrates exceptional depth: detailed explanation, rich examples, practical guidance, and clear insight into why this area matters to the chosen sector.	One area demonstrates good depth with solid explanation and relevant examples.	One area shows a reasonable attempt at depth but lacks sufficient detail or application.	Depth is attempted but the chosen area is explained only at a surface level.	No area demonstrates meaningful depth beyond the general coverage.	5%